



FIFTH CASTLE MEDIA
MELBOURNE

The Twelve Jobs You Shouldn't **Still** Be Doing

What an AI chief of staff actually takes off a founder's desk, why chat keeps failing at it, and what it takes to build one around your business.

AREK RAINCZUK

FIFTH CASTLE MEDIA

I was an early believer, and it still wouldn't do the work.

The day ChatGPT came out I was all over it. I taught myself to use it properly: prompt engineering, projects, custom instructions, the lot. I run two video production companies and I'm a scientist by training, so I'm not squeamish about learning a system. And I kept hitting the same wall. The best it could do was write me a mediocre email that I still had to copy, paste and fix.

That's the wall most founders are standing at. You open a chat, you explain your business, your prices, the way you speak. You get a decent answer, after a few tries. You copy it out, close the tab, and tomorrow you do it all again. Saved projects and polished prompts capture some of it, sure. But those are sticky notes. There aren't many of them and they keep falling off. The answer was free. The work was still yours.

What follows is the honest version of what changed for me, written for someone who hasn't bought anything and might never. The first part is the useful bit: twelve jobs an AI chief of staff genuinely takes off a founder's desk, described concretely enough that you can hold each one against your own week. Then why a chat window can't do them, what "built around your business" actually requires from you, and what it costs. There's a section on who this isn't for, and I mean it.

Somewhere along the way I stopped opening chat windows and started running a business. I haven't opened one this year.

AREK RAINCZUK

One thing to set expectations before you start. Everything below that sounds like a result is either mine, documented from my own two companies, or a founder's own words with their permission attached. I'm not going to tell you how many hours you'll save. I don't know your business yet.

The work that sits between you and getting paid

These are the twelve jobs I hear about most from founders, and the twelve my own system does every week. Read them as a checklist against your own desk. Each one ends with the honest bit: what still needs you.

01 Draft the quote from the conversation you just had

You come off a call and describe what the client wants, out loud, in the messy way you'd tell a colleague. The quote comes back priced off your own structure, with your own inclusions and exclusions, in your own format, ready to check. The pricing logic is yours, taught once. You're editing a draft instead of staring at a blank page at nine at night.

STILL YOURS The number. It proposes, you decide, always.

02 Chase what you're owed

It knows what's been invoiced, what's landed, and how long each one's been sitting. When something's late it writes the reminder the way you'd write it, firm and friendly, with the invoice number and the date already in it. Payment chasing stops being a job you avoid because it's awkward and becomes a draft you approve.

STILL YOURS Hitting send, and any call that needs a human voice.

03 Tell you where you actually stand

Most founders I talk to can't answer three questions off the top of their head: what's out the door unpaid, what's in the pipeline and at what stage, and what's due to land this month. Not because the information doesn't exist, but because it's spread across an inbox, an accounting tool and a spreadsheet that's three weeks stale. A chief of staff keeps that picture current and hands it to you in plain English when you ask.

STILL YOURS The decisions the numbers ask for.

The work that happens after the phone rings

04 Answer the new enquiry before it goes cold

An enquiry comes in while you're on site. The reply that gets drafted knows your availability, your usual starting point on price, the two questions you always ask first, and the tone you use with a stranger who might become a client. Speed wins work. Most of the time you lose a job to whoever answered first, not whoever was best.

STILL YOURS Reading the person. Some enquiries deserve a phone call, and it'll tell you which.

05 Chase the second touch

This is the one that leaks money in every business I've looked at, including mine. The first follow-up gets sent. The second, the one that actually converts, gets forgotten because nothing was tracking it. A chief of staff holds every open thread with a date on it and surfaces the ones that have gone quiet, with a draft attached.

STILL YOURS Deciding when a prospect is done and letting it go.

06 Turn a messy call into a one-page brief

You talk for forty minutes with a client. What your team needs is a page: what we're making, for whom, what it has to do, the dates, the constraints, what was promised out loud. That page normally costs you an hour of writing, so it either gets skipped or it gets written badly at midnight. Handing over a recording or a set of notes and getting the brief back is one of the most useful things a chief of staff does.

STILL YOURS The judgement call about what the work actually needs to achieve.

07 Write the delivery note and the hand-over

The email that goes with the finished work, the one that frames what you did and why, and asks for the review at the right moment. Contractors briefed with the same information every time. The small courteous messages that make a client feel looked after and that you skip when you're busy, which is exactly when they matter.

STILL YOURS Quality control on the work itself.

The work that quietly eats your evenings

08

Keep the trackers honest

Whatever you use to keep score, a spreadsheet, a project tool, a CRM you half set up two years ago, it drifts the moment you get busy. A chief of staff reconciles it against what actually happened and tells you what it changed. In my own business it does this without being asked, which is the difference between a system and a to-do list.

STILL YOURS Telling it when something changed offline.

09

Turn meeting notes into dated actions with owners

Every commitment made in a meeting, including the ones you made out loud without writing down, becomes a task with a name and a date on it. This is unglamorous and it's probably the highest-value job on this list. Most things don't fail in my businesses because we chose wrong. They fail because nobody wrote down who was doing it and by when.

STILL YOURS Actually doing the ones with your name on them.

10

Produce the document, on brand, first time

Proposals, price lists, one-pagers, agreements, the pack you send a new client. Same fonts, same structure, same voice, whether it's you writing it at 6am or a team member writing it while you're away. Version drift across documents is a slow tax that nobody notices until a client quotes an old price back at you.

STILL YOURS Signing anything legal, and any number on it.

The work that's ready before you sit down

11

Hand you the morning

Mine writes me a brief overnight. What's happening across both companies, what's overdue, what needs a call from me before anything else, and what it's already drafted while I was asleep. I read it before I open anything else. These days it's the only app I open, and I've been cancelling subscriptions, because one system that knows the business replaces a stack of apps that don't.

STILL YOURS Choosing what to ignore. A good brief gives you more options, not fewer.

12

Do the homework before you dial

Before a call: who they are, what they do, what you've said to each other before, what you quoted last time and whether it landed, what they've published lately, and the two questions worth opening with. Ten minutes of preparation that you never actually do, done every time.

STILL YOURS The conversation. That's the part worth your morning.

And the one that sits underneath all twelve

The jobs above are outputs. What makes them hold together is that a decision you make once travels everywhere it's relevant, without you chasing it.

Here's a real one. I decided school pick-up is mine, and I take no meetings after three. One sentence, spoken once. It updated what the system remembers about how I work, my calendar availability rules, the hours on my booking page and the email templates that offer people times. I didn't visit four places and change four settings. A decision made is a decision implemented.

That's the difference between something that answers you and something that works for you. Every founder I've built one with hits that moment and it's the point they stop treating it like software.

WORTH DOING EVEN IF YOU NEVER BUILD ONE

Take the twelve above and mark each one A, B or C. A means it's handled and you're happy. B means it happens, badly or late. C means it doesn't happen at all and you know it's costing you. Most founders I show this to come back with two As. The Cs are usually 05, 09 and 12, and they're usually the ones nearest the money.

A brilliant intern who forgets everything overnight

If you've tried to get a chatbot to do any of the twelve, you already know something's off, and you've probably assumed it's you. It isn't. There are two specific gaps, and once you can name them the whole thing makes sense.

The memory gap

A chat window starts from nothing every time. You explain your prices, your clients, your tone, your rules, and it does a decent job with what you gave it. Then the session ends and all of that context goes with it. Tomorrow you type it again, slightly differently, and get a slightly different answer. That's the re-explaining tax and you pay it every single day.

Projects and saved prompts help, and I used them hard for two years. But they're a handful of notes stuck to the outside of the thing. They don't grow, they don't correct themselves when you change your mind, and they can't hold the level of detail a real business runs on: this client's history, that promise you made in March, the price you moved last week, the person you don't work with any more and why.

The agency gap

The second gap is bigger. A chatbot answers questions. It doesn't move the work. It can write you an excellent follow-up email and then sit there while you copy it into your mail app, find the address, fix the formatting and press send. It can tell you your tracker looks out of date. It can't go and fix it.

Everything on the twelve-job list is work, not answers. Work means opening things, changing things, writing to files, keeping records, and being trusted to do it without supervision on the small stuff.

That's a different category of tool, and it's the category that arrived properly in the last couple of years while everyone was still typing into a chat box.

Chat is simply not the right tool. It's like trying to build a deck with a screwdriver. For running a business it won't do.

TAMIR BERKMAN, FOUNDER, BERKMAN ACADEMY

Levels, so you can place yourself

Being good at chat is level one. Projects, saved prompts and custom instructions, call that level two. Both are still the kindergarten of this. The level above is a system built around one business that holds its own memory, reads and writes its own records, and carries out work. That's the shift, and it's a bigger jump than the one from no AI to chat.

Most founders who tell me they're across AI are at level one and don't know there's a level two, let alone what's above it. That's not a criticism. It's just where the public conversation stopped.

You're not buying software. You're teaching a hire.

"Bespoke" is one of those words that usually means nothing, so here's what it means here: the value isn't in the architecture, it's in what goes into it. Two founders can start from the same foundation and end up with systems that behave nothing alike, because they brought different things to it.

What you bring is this.

Your prices, and how you get to them

Not a rate card. The reasoning. Why a job is \$4,000 and not \$2,500, what pushes it up, what you throw in, what you refuse to discount, how you handle GST, when you walk away. Most founders have never said this out loud in one sitting. Doing it is worth the session on its own.

Your voice, from things you've actually sent

Real emails, real proposals, real messages, the good ones and the ones you'd write again. Voice is learned from evidence, not from adjectives. Telling a system to be "warm and professional" produces exactly the beige nothing you'd expect. Feeding it thirty of your own sent emails produces something your clients don't clock as written by anything other than you.

Your clients and what you've promised each of them

Who they are, what's been done, what's outstanding, what was said on a call that never made it into writing, who's difficult about what. This is the part that lives only in your head today, and it's the reason everything routes through you.

Your tools, as they already are

Whatever you run on now. The point is that it works with what you've got rather than asking you to migrate to something new in the same month you're learning a new way of working. If a tool of yours is holding you back we'll talk about it, but not in week one.

Your rules

The lines you don't cross. Nothing goes to a client without you seeing it. Never quote below X. Never book me after three on a school day. Always flag anything with a legal implication. These are the ones that turn it from a clever assistant into something you can actually let off the leash.

Your standard for "good"

What a great proposal looks like versus an acceptable one. Which of your own past jobs you'd hold up as the benchmark. Correcting it when it gets something wrong is how it learns, the same way it works with a new team member, and it sticks the first time.

None of this is technical. All of it is stuff you already know and have never written down. That's the actual work of the build, and it's why I can't do it for you while you're out.

WHAT THE BUILD LOOKS LIKE

Six short sessions, on your machine, with me over your shoulder

Six sessions over about a fortnight, two or three a week, on Google Meet. Roughly four and a half to six hours in the room all up. Short sessions on purpose, because this is easier in small doses with a couple of days of using it in between.

What I do

I bring the architecture and six months of my own mistakes, research and fine-tuning, so you don't repeat any of it. You start at about level seven out of ten on day one rather than at zero. I ask you the questions that get what's in your head onto the page, I set it up while you watch, and I tell you honestly when something isn't worth doing yet.

What you do

Talk, record, approve. You explain how your business works, out loud, the way you'd explain it to a new employee who's sharp but knows nothing about you. You bring real material: recent emails, a proposal you're proud of, your actual price list, a live problem from this week. And you use it between sessions, because the friction you hit on your own Tuesday is what session four is for.

Where it runs

On your own machine, Mac or PC, in plain instructions you own. Not on my server, not in a platform you rent from me. If you and I never speak again, everything keeps working.

What "done" means

Done isn't when I stop turning up. Done is the session where you build something in it yourself, unaided, while I sit there and say nothing. That moment is the actual deliverable. Every founder I've worked with can name the day it happened.

After that there's on-demand support when you get stuck, and a thirty-day window where I'm on the end of a message. The goal I'm building towards the whole time is that you stop needing me. My job is to make myself unnecessary, and I can't claim that and also design you into a retainer.

THE HONEST BIT

The build is a fortnight. The teaching carries on after that, and one of my clients said it better than I have: "It takes more than a fortnight teaching it." He's right. The architecture goes in during the fortnight, then you're onboarding it into your business for a while after, the same as you would with a good hire. Anyone telling you it's finished and perfect on day fourteen is selling you something.

The questions founders ask me on the first call

Arek spent two days with my members last week and handed over the entire AI operating system he's built, no holding back. The room shifted in front of me: people who came in unsure walked out building.

DEN LENNIE, FOUNDER, VIDEO BUSINESS ACCELERATOR

Do I need to be technical?

No, and I'd rather you weren't trying to be. Your three jobs are talk, record, approve. If you can explain your business out loud to a person, you can teach it to a chief of staff. What you do need is baseline computer confidence: you already run your business from a laptop, you can install an app and follow a set-up prompt without dread. That's the real qualifier, not coding.

What does it actually run on?

Your own computer, Mac or PC. It runs on today's best models, currently Claude, and it isn't welded to them. When a sharper model lands, yours gets sharper the same week, with no rebuild and no new invoice. That's the opposite of most software you buy, which is at its best the day you buy it.

What happens to my data?

It stays on your machine, in files you own and can read, not in a database I control. There's no client portal of mine that holds your business. If you're in a field with real confidentiality obligations, and several of the founders I work with are, we set the boundaries in the build: what it's allowed to hold, what never goes near it, what always needs your eyes first. Those rules are part of the thing, not a policy document you file away.

What if I get stuck after you leave?

You ask it. That sounds glib, and it's the honest answer: the system is the thing that helps you extend the system, and by the end of the build you'll have done that in front of me. Beyond that, you've got on-demand support during the build and a thirty-day window after. And there's no lock-in, so if you want out, you take everything with you, because it was always on your machine.

What does it cost?

The build is \$5,500 ex GST. It's not a subscription, there's no retainer behind it, and you own what we build. The first three founders get it at \$2,500 + GST, in exchange for an honest testimonial at the end and one introduction to someone it would suit. Payment is half to lock the dates, half on go-live.

How long until it's actually useful?

Useful in the first week, because the first session gets it holding real context about your business. Genuinely load-bearing takes longer, closer to a month of you using it and correcting it. I'd rather tell you that now than have you feel misled in week two. The founders who get the most out of it are the ones who bring it a real problem every couple of days early on.

Won't this all be out of date in six months?

The opposite, and this is the part people find counter-intuitive. It isn't an app that ships and then ages. It's a set of instructions that runs on whatever the best model is that week, so it improves underneath you without you doing anything. Most tools lose value from the day you buy them. This one compounds.

FOUNDERS WHO'VE BUILT THEIR OWN

"It feels like having a second set of hands rather than another app to babysit."

ISAAC VIGLIONE, BLOOM FILMS

"It's like having an extra person on the team who knows the whole business. The best part is it sounds like us, not like a robot."

JESS VIEIRA, ZARCO CREATIVE

"I've built a system that actually runs the way my brain works and holds my whole business."

JOSE FERNANDEZ, SPECK OF DUST

"Arek helped us build the foundations of an AI operating system that is already delivering real value."

ORVILLE, GREATER VISUALS

"Arek really unlocked how to connect it all together and make it work for me, not just with me."

MATT SMOLEN, BALLOON TREE PRODUCTIONS

Six reasons I'd tell you not to do it

I'd rather lose a sale than run a build that was never going to work. If you recognise yourself below, don't book the call, and I'll say the same thing on it if it comes up.

— You want it done for you

This is done with you. If your intention is to hand over your business and collect a working system in a fortnight, you'll be disappointed and I'll have wasted your money. The value comes out of your head. There's no version of this where you're not in the room.

— You can't give it the hours

Six sessions plus using it in between. If the next month is a shoot schedule from hell or you're about to go overseas, wait. It'll still be here, and it'll be better.

— Computers are a genuine struggle

I've learned this one the hard way. If installing software and following a set-up prompt is a real barrier rather than a mild annoyance, this build will frustrate both of us. Not technical is fine. Not comfortable with a computer at all isn't.

— You've got a big team and want everyone on it

This is built for the founder who's the bottleneck, and for small teams where that founder stays at the controls. A rollout across a large team is a different piece of work with different questions, and I'd scope it separately rather than pretend this is it.

— You want another subscription to hand off and forget

You're hiring, not installing. You brief it, you correct it, and you keep teaching it. Several of my clients have cancelled other tools after building theirs, which tells you what it replaces, but none of them got there by leaving it alone.

— You won't say out loud how you really price and decide

Some founders can't, or won't, articulate the reasoning behind their own numbers and standards. That's fair, plenty of it is instinct. But this build runs on exactly that material, and without it you'll get a polite general-purpose assistant instead of a chief of staff.

THE NEXT STEP

Bring me your messiest week

If any of the twelve jobs landed, the next move is a short call. It's me on it, not a salesperson, and I'll show you my own system doing real work rather than describing it. Bring the week you've got, not a tidied-up version. Worst case, you leave knowing what an agentic system would do in your business and you go and build it yourself.

FOUNDING PRICE / FIRST THREE BUILDS ONLY

~~\$5,500~~ **\$2,500** + GST

Three places below the standing price of \$5,500 ex GST, in exchange for a short honest testimonial at the end and one introduction. Once they're taken it's \$5,500 ex GST. Half to lock your dates, half on go-live.

BOOK A CALL

Thirty minutes, with me, no pitch deck

portal.fifthcastle.media/schedule/call-with-arek

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